



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Medina Christian Academy

School Website: <https://www.heritageclassicalacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Medina Christian Academy (Medina, OH, 44256) is represented in the crawl data as Heritage Classical Academy (HCA) with campuses in Pepper Pike, Peninsula, Bainbridge, and Northfield. The material presents Heritage Classical Academy as a classical Christian school operating on a Trivium-based framework (Grammar/K-5, Logic/6-8, Rhetoric/9-12) with a strong emphasis on Christian worldview formation, virtue formation, and a “Great Conversation” with Western civilization’s canonical texts. Public materials repeatedly frame education as formation in Christ and in virtue, with explicit liturgical and communal practices (chapel, hymnody, worship), strong family/parent partnership, and a living-faculty-centered model. The school consistently positions itself against purely information-transfer or career-prep aims, instead foregrounding truth, goodness, beauty, and the cultivation of character.

- Core aggregate classification: CLASSICAL.
- Category-by-category snapshot: all six categories show alignment with classical aims, with explicit evidence of Trivium-based curriculum, liturgical/community practices, formation-first aims, and robust faculty/parent partnership.
- Abstract takeaway: Heritage Classical Academy (as reflected in the Medina/Ohio presence within the crawl content) demonstrates a comprehensive classical Christian program: three-stage grammar/-logic/rhetoric curriculum; integrated history and Great Conversation framing; contemplative/socratic pedagogy at the high school level; faculty as living curriculum; and active parent partnerships and church/community alignment.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The public materials repeatedly frame education in a Christ-centered, theologically oriented framework. For example, one page states: “They know what they believe and why. Academic subjects are interrelated and integrated with God and His Word at the center. Students are prepared to serve Christ and His kingdom as they are equipped to labor for Him regardless of their calling.”
- The materials emphasize a liturgical/communal rhythm (e.g., chapel, worship) and integration with local churches and guest speakers. For instance, chapel is described as a twice-monthly extended gathering to sing and study God’s word, with partner churches providing guest speakers.
- Public pages explicitly center Christ in the curriculum and family formation, including mission/vision statements and references to living within a Christian worldview.
- Evidence of liturgical/worship culture appears in teaching and student life materials, including references to church life and worship practices.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords identified in the site: Christ-centered, God’s Word at the center, chapel, worship, theology, liturgy, sacred, Christian worldview, gospel, Great Conversation, truth/beauty/goodness, virtue, spiritual depth, mentorship, imago Dei.
- Negative keywords (from the classical lexicon): secular, values-neutral, religiously neutral, pluralistic without theology, relativism.

- Quantitative note: Multiple explicit hits for positive religious/metaphysical indicators across the materials; no explicit hits for negative secular keywords observed in the public materials.
- Why this rating: The school's public materials underscore transcendental/Christian foundations and liturgical practices. The presence of chapel, theology-centered framing, and Christ-centered mission strongly aligns with CLASSICAL in this category.

Cited evidence anchors:

- Christ-centered, God-centered framing and integration with Word at the center.
- Twice-a-month chapel and worship with guest speakers.
- Mission/vision statements tying learning to Christ and a Christian worldview.

Why this rating

- The materials show a deliberate metaphysical and religious grounding, with explicit liturgical/community rhythms and theological integration, matching the Positive keywords in the Six Essentials lexicon and strongly supporting a CLASSICAL orientation in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school communicates a formation-focused aim: education should form virtue and wisdom, not merely prepare students for work or college acceptance. A key passage notes: "This good life is not high scores on standardized tests, a lucrative career, or college acceptance" but rather the cultivation of virtue and rightly ordered affections. This is a direct statement of formation over mere information or career prep.
- Mission statements repeatedly articulate forming lifelong learners who think and live for Christ, emphasizing virtue and character formation as the telos of education.
- References to classical goals (truth, goodness, beauty) and uplifted aims (formation of character, moral imagination, wisdom) appear in campaign and program descriptions.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords identified: formation, virtue, wisdom, character, wise conduct, classical mission, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, scholé (restful contemplation), love of learning, moral imagination, imitation of the good.
- Negative keywords (from the lexicon): career/workforce readiness, 21st-century skills emphasis, test-focused outcomes, vocational training without formation.
- Quantitative note: Positive indicators are numerous and explicit; there is minimal to no emphasis on workforce-first language in the public materials.
- Why this rating: The materials foreground formation and virtue as primary aims, with explicit critique of reducing education to information, tests, or job prep, consistent with CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence anchors:

- "This good life is not high scores on standardized tests, a lucrative career, or college acceptance."
- Mission statement: "Cultivating lifelong learners who think and live for Christ" (formation focus).

Why this rating

- The overarching aim is formation and virtue rather than instrumental outcomes; the public materials align with classical teleology (truth, goodness, beauty) and emphasize formation, making CLASSICAL the proper rating for this category.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum structure is clearly identified as a Trivium framework: Grammar School (K-5), Logic School (6-8), Rhetoric School (9-12). This is explicit on the public pages.
- The site describes three-track progression (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and notes the addition of high school-level Rhetoric with the Great Conversation emphasis. The Peninsula and Pepper Pike campuses host the Rhetoric track with emphasis on rhetoric, speeches, and oratory.
- The curriculum is described as “classical Christian education” with explicit reference to Great Conversation and engagement with classical texts. The Rhetoric School page explicitly highlights the Great Conversation as a capstone concept for high school.
- Great Books / Great Conversation framing is supported in multiple materials, including the Rhetoric School pages and curriculum-night communications. The Great Conversation framing is central to the public narrative.
- History and integrated humanities emphasis: The materials present history as an integrated part of the curriculum (interdisciplinary integration and history across subjects). The site repeatedly frames history in a cross-disciplinary, canonical, and Western-civilization context.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords identified: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Seven Liberal Arts, Trivium, Quadrivium, Great Books/Great Conversation, history, interdisciplinary/harmony of subjects, wonder, primary texts, classical canon, Western civilization, Latin/classical languages (as implied by the Trivium framework).
- Negative keywords (from the lexicon): Social studies-centric history instead of history (as a separate subject), project-based or purely experiential approaches that replace the Great Conversation, purely STEM-first framing, and other non-classical curricular framings.
- Quantitative note: The site shows frequent classical curriculum keywords (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Conversation, history-integrated, Great Books framing). There is no overt emphasis on social studies-only framing or a project-based override in the public materials.
- Why this rating: The curriculum is presented squarely within the classical canon (Trivium, Great Conversation, integration of history with humanities, and a history-rich, canonical curriculum). This aligns with CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence anchors:

- Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric structure and K-12 progression.
- Great Conversation and rhetoric-capstone emphasis in the Rhetoric School materials.
- Interdisciplinary, history-rich curriculum framing.

Why this rating

- The explicit Trivium-based curriculum and the explicit Great Conversation framing indicate a robust classical curriculum orientation. History is integrated across the curriculum rather than treated as a standalone social-studies track, and the Seven Liberal Arts are foregrounded through the grammar-/logic/rhetoric progression.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Pedagogical approach is described as a mix of contemplative/restful elements and more rigorous, Socratic/argumentative elements. The lower grades emphasize memory work, singing, and regular review, while the upper grades emphasize rhetoric and eloquence (speeches, oratory, and debate). For example, the Rhetoric School emphasizes rhetoric training, speeches, and the “great conversation,” which implies seminar-like discourse and dialectic.
- Lower-school practices include singing, memory work, and communal song as part of a habit-forming pedagogy; the materials emphasize wonder and joyful learning in the early grades (Scholé-like approach). The chapel/music/worship rhythm also supports contemplative, reverent modes of learning.
- Upper-school pedagogy explicitly includes Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetorical training as students prepare for public-speaking and argument presentation (Rhetoric track).

- The school's public materials consistently describe the pedagogy as forming through great teachers, living content, and the Great Conversation—i.e., a Seminars/Scholé mix with rhetoric practice.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords identified: Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, rhetoric, speeches, oratory, memorization, chanting, singing, scholé, wonder, contemplative learning, living curriculum, teacher as mentor, classical pedagogy, great conversation.
- Negative keywords (from the lexicon): strictly project-based focus, exclusively experiential learning, constructivist-only approaches that downplay the Great Conversation.
- Quantitative note: The public materials show explicit references to Socratic/seminar-style learning at the high school level and to memory/music-based lower-grade pedagogy, with clear emphasis on rhetoric and Great Conversation rather than a purely project-based frame.
- Why this rating: The pedagogy aligns with classical norms: contemplative elements (Scholé), memory-rituals (chanting/memorization), and high-school rhetoric/seminars. The mix of contemplative and dialogue-based methods, plus the rhetoric-focused upper grades, places it squarely in CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence anchors:

- Lower-grade singing/memory and contemplative rhythm.
- Upper-grade Socratic/seminar and rhetoric training; public speaking emphasis.
- Mention of the Great Conversation and living content as pedagogy.

Why this rating

- The pedagogy intentionally reflects classical methods (Scholé-like contemplation in parts, memorization/singing, and high-school seminars/rhetoric). The explicit rhetoric/seminar elements and the overall blend of contemplative and dialectical learning justify CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Faculty pages present a professional, mission-aligned team, with titles (Head of School, Associate Head of School, Campus Coordinators, subject-area teachers) and a portrayal of teachers as leaders and mentors in a living curriculum. The materials emphasize faculty roles as models of virtue and as the core of the school (the living curriculum).
- The site highlights a culture of collegiality and mentorship among teachers and staff, with pages describing faculty as exemplars and living curricula, and with leadership profiles and teacher pictures.
- The faculty pages connect with grade-level and track leadership (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) across campuses, indicating a stable instructional leadership structure aligned with classical pedagogy.
- The materials show a named faculty/staff roster and campus leadership, signaling a deliberate "portrait of a teacher" and teacher-leadership culture.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords identified: living curriculum, model teachers, mentors, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, teacher leadership, master/guide imagery.
- Negative keywords: None evident in public materials (no emphasis on "teacher as technician," no credentialing-only framing, etc.).
- Quantitative note: Multiple explicit vocational/character-forming teacher-role indicators appear; no negative indicators are evident in the public materials.
- Why this rating: The materials emphasize teachers as virtuous exemplars and cores of the school's culture, consistent with a CLASSICAL profile for the faculty dimension.

Cited evidence anchors:

- Faculty pages and "living curriculum" language.
- Leadership profiles and campus roles aligned with classical pedagogy.

- Portrait of the Teacher/Faculty culture (collegiality, mentors).

Why this rating

- The public materials present a fulfillment of the Classical criterion for faculty: model-teacher mentors, living curriculum, and a strong faculty culture anchored in virtue and pedagogy. This aligns with CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The materials foreground a strong partnership with families and explicitly position parents as co-educators within the classical framework. For example, “Curriculum and mission are presented in partnership with parents,” and there are clear sections for prospective families and parent involvement.
- Family involvement programs are highlighted through admissions events, tours, and ongoing family engagement; there are references to parent boards, volunteer opportunities, and family-oriented communications (Family Night, orientation, etc.).
- The evidence includes detailed information about volunteer opportunities, parent formation, and “Heritage Association of Parents (HAP)” or similar family networks, linking with the public messaging about parent partnership.
- The site emphasizes open-campus visits, parent formation efforts (book studies, gatherings), and opportunities for families to participate widely in school life.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords identified: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental engagement, family formation, parent book studies, open campus, visiting, volunteer opportunities, parent leadership, school-parent synergy, community of learners.
- Negative keywords: consumer language, minimal parent involvement, distance between home and school life (none observed in the public materials).
- Quantitative note: The site includes numerous explicit parent-partnership signals; negative signals are absent.
- Why this rating: The school foregrounds deep parent involvement, family formation, and ongoing collaboration, which aligns with CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence anchors:

- Partnership with families and co-educators language.
- Open campus visits and parent involvement; volunteer forms/resources.
- Parent formation opportunities and family-oriented governance/communication.

Why this rating

- The public materials demonstrate robust parental engagement and family partnership consistent with classical expectations for parents as co-educators and community participants in the school’s life.

Overall Assessment and Aggregate Ranking

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Aggregate: CLASSICAL

Notes on evidence and rubric alignment

- The “Six Essential Elements of a Classical School” lexicon (positive indicators such as truth/goodness/beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, wonder, Great Conversation, Trivium, Great Books; and formation-focused language) is reflected across the Heritage Classical Academy public materials (as captured in the crawl data). Positive indicators are heavily present across all six categories, with explicit references such as Christ-centered formation, chapel, Great Conversation, Trivium-based curriculum, rhetoric training, and parent partnership. See the classical-lexicon evidence set for alignment with these keywords and concepts.
- The curriculum, pedagogy, and structure align with the canonical classicist framework: Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric; history-integrated curriculum; Great Conversation; contemplative pedagogy mixed with Socratic/seminar-style upper-level activities; and a living-teacher faculty model in a liturgical Christian community. Public materials show explicit references to Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric, Great Conversation, and the liturgical rhythms that accompany the classical formation model.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
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